

white people who helped them, and institutions that aided Black citizens, such as schools and churches.

Some Southern states tried to curb Klan activities, but the laws were often weak or not enforced. Republicans appealed to Congress, which passed the Ku Klux Act in 1871. This act was enforced by Federal troops, not state militia, and cases were tried in Federal court where juries had many Black members. Hundreds of Klan members were convicted, but much damage had already been done—Klan terrorism had stopped Black Americans from voting and weakened the leadership of the Republican Party in the South.



Klan violence

His face concealed in a hood, a Klu Klux Klan member takes aim at a Black family at home in their cabin, with his accomplices looking on. A wave of violence against Black people swept through the Southern states after the war.